

Ivy Graduate Programs Student Handbook

Master of Finance

2024-2025

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Program Overview

The Master of Finance (MFin) is designed to prepare students for careers in corporate finance, financial analysis, investing and wealth management, and risk management. The Ivy College of Business MFin is a STEM-designated program, and emphasizes more quantitative methods and skills than either an undergraduate finance degree or an MBA program. As the field of Finance has become more quantitative, employers are increasingly asking for and valuing hard analytical skills. Additionally, the STEM designation allows international students the opportunity to extend their Optional Practical Training (OPT) work permit for up to 36 months after graduation.

Among other core finance topics such as financial analysis and valuation, MFin students will learn advanced regression techniques and programming approaches for data analysis, time series analysis and forecasting, use of probability distributions, optimization techniques, modelling of financial and risk variables, simulation techniques, value at risk measurement, and tools for effective risk management. These tools will equip students to effectively analyze and solve problems encountered in today's rapidly changing financial environment.

The Ivy College of Business MFin program is designed to meet the diverse needs of recent undergraduates, finance professionals, economists, engineers, computer scientists, and others who are considering a new career in the field of finance.

We welcome you to the Iowa State University Ivy MFin program. We are absolutely committed to providing you with a rewarding and valuable educational experience.

Independent Study

The pedagogical intent of the Independent Study, 590, course is to provide an individualized project/research experience for MFin students guided by a faculty in the Ivy College of Business. Each independent study must generate a research project and a documented academic paper under the direction of the faculty member. It is the faculty member's prerogative to agree or not to serve as a project adviser.

Employment and internships do not constitute in and of themselves a sufficient basis for independent study credit. If the experience generates research project potential, then credit may be negotiated.

To enroll in an independent study, MFin students must first complete the Independent Study Request Form available in the Graduate Business Programs Office or at;
<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/masters/files/2016/12/Independent-Study-Agreement.pdf>

The completed and signed request form is then submitted to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office to receive course registration information. A maximum of three credits of independent study may be applied toward the MFin degree.

International Study Opportunities

Ivy MFin students are encouraged to consider international study as part of their MFin experience. International study opportunities provide valuable insights into global business practices and a heightened awareness of cultural diversity. Interested students should contact the DOGE.

Ivy MFin Degree Requirements

The Ivy MFIN requires a minimum of 30 credit hours consisting of 18 hours of graduate finance courses, a minimum of six credits of graduate finance courses from an approved list, and at least six credits of other graduate electives from an approved list.

Waiver of Iowa State MFin required courses is rare, requiring special permission from the DOGE. A waived core course requires a replacement elective with the equivalent credit hours.

MFin students may also add a Graduate Certificate to their study plan. The Ivy College of Business offers Graduate Certificates in Business Analytics, Enterprise Cybersecurity Management, Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Finance, and Supply Chain Management. Ivy Graduate Certificates require 12 credits of which nine can be applied as MFin electives.

Students need to work closely with the DOGE to develop a study plan and to assure degree requirements are being met.

MFin Elective Policy Guidelines

The Ivy MFin requires students to satisfactorily complete two graduate elective courses (6 credits). You may choose an area of specialization; however, you are also expected to maintain sufficient breadth in your selection of elective coursework.

MFin Transfer Credits

Transfer of MFin course credits from other academic institutions to the Ivy MFin is limited and requires approval to be included on a student's study plan. The university must have AACSB accreditation in order for transfer credit to be considered. The length of time since the requested transfer courses were taken is also a factor. Generally, transfer credit applies to elective coursework, not the required core courses, within the Ivy MFin program.

A final course grade of "B" or higher must be received on all transfer coursework. An official graduate transcript from the institution from which transfer credit has been approved must be submitted to the Ivy Graduate Programs Office.

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